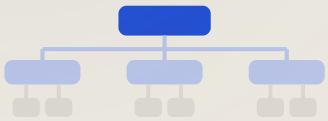
Evaluating Product Ideas

Judge an idea before you build it, buy cheap evidence, and let that evidence move the plan.

FROM OUTCOME TO A TESTED IDEA

Opportunity solution tree TORRES

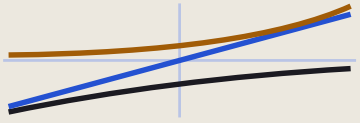


→ turn one request into a choice

Outcome → opportunities (customers' words) → **2+ solutions each** → assumption tests

⚠ one solution per branch = the backlog sideways

Kano model KANO, 1984



● attractive ● performance ● must-be

→ how customers feel with it and without it

Must-be: get to good enough, then stop. **Attractive decays.** Reverse = design a guardrail.

⚠ wording alone swung one result 59% → 22%

Lean Startup RIES, 2011

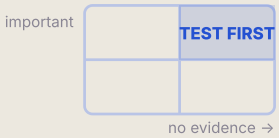
build → measure → learn ↻

→ the cheapest test that could change your mind

Concierge · Wizard of Oz · fake door · demo video. Write the decision rule first.

⚠ a fake door measures curiosity, not payment

Assumption map BLAND



→ pick the one assumption to test first

⚠ favourite assumptions filed as proven

Test card OSTERWALDER

We believe	hypothesis
To verify	the test
And measure	the metric
We're right if	**criterion, agreed first**

→ before anyone runs anything

⚠ a pass says keep going, not "proven"

Product-market fit ELLIS · VOHRA



→ is it working yet, and for whom?

Superhuman: **22% → 58%** by building for the segment that loved it.

⚠ a low total can hide a segment above 40%

THREE RULES

Start from the outcome, not the feature.

Write the pass line before the test.

Let the evidence move the inputs, then the ranking.

WHEN THESE MISLEAD YOU

The tree: only as good as the research under it

Small tests: keen volunteers, no control group

Kano: feelings, not usage or payment; start a conversation

A PMF score: swings with who you ask

Evidence before ranking. Then let the evidence move the ranking.

Sources: Torres, *Continuous Discovery Habits* (2021); Kano et al. (1984); Mikulić & Prebežac (2011); Ries, *The Lean Startup* (2011); Bland and Osterwalder, Strategyzer; Vohra, First Round Review (2018).